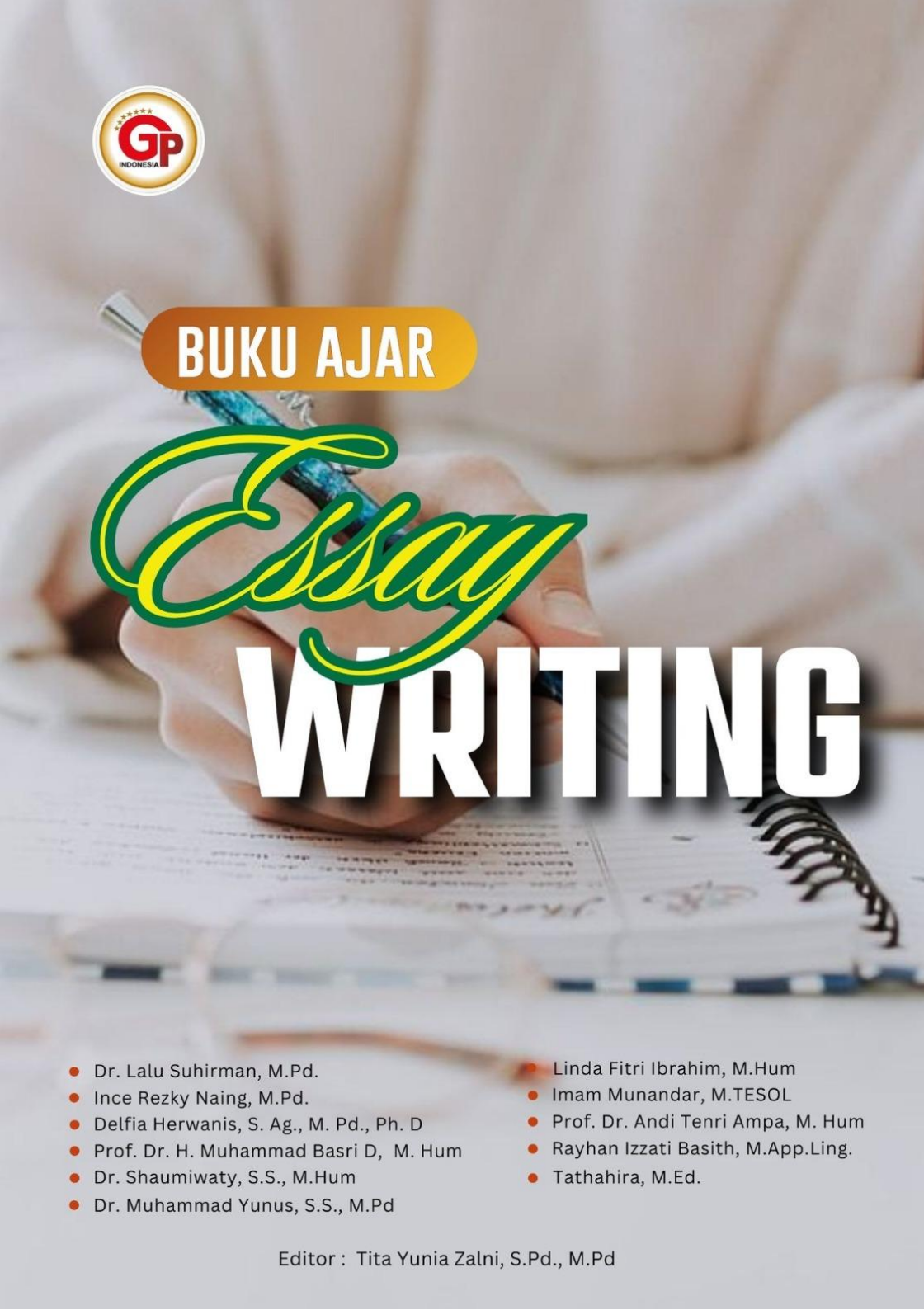


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Essay WRITING

- Dr. Lalu Suhirman, M.Pd.
- Ince Rezky Naing, M.Pd.
- Delfia Herwanis, S. Ag., M. Pd., Ph. D
- Prof. Dr. H. Muhammad Basri D, M. Hum
- Dr. Shaumiwaty, S.S., M.Hum
- Dr. Muhammad Yunus, S.S., M.Pd
- Linda Fitri Ibrahim, M.Hum
- Imam Munandar, M.TESOL
- Prof. Dr. Andi Tenri Ampa, M. Hum
- Rayhan Izzati Basith, M.App.Ling.
- Tathahira, M.Ed.

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PREFACE

Praise be to God Almighty for His blessings and grace, through which this textbook entitled **"ESSAY WRITING"** has been successfully completed. This book is written as an effort to help students understand and master the skills of writing academic essays in English in a systematic and structured manner. Essay writing is one of the essential components of academic study, as it requires critical thinking, logical organization, and coherent expression.

This textbook focuses on three main types of academic essays commonly used in academic writing courses: *comparison and contrast essay*, *cause and effect essay*, and *argumentative essay*. Each chapter is organized progressively, beginning with conceptual understanding, followed by the development of *topic sentences* and *supporting sentences*, the creation of an *outline*, and the process of *drafting* and *editing*. Through this structured approach, it is expected that students will be able to comprehend each stage of essay writing and produce well-organized, logical, and academically sound compositions.

In addition to theoretical discussions, this book also includes practical examples, exercises, and relevant references to support the learning process. Thus, it not only serves as a reading material but also as a practical guide for students to enhance their academic writing competence.

Finally, the author hopes that this book will provide meaningful benefits, particularly for students, lecturers, and anyone interested in improving their academic writing skills in English. Constructive feedback and suggestions for improvement are warmly welcomed for the refinement of future editions.

Jayapura, October 2025

Authors

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CHAPTER 1
TOPIC SENTENCE AND SUPPORTING SENTENCE OF COMPARISON AND CONTRAST ESSAY

Dr. Lalu Suhirman, M.Pd

A. Introduction

Comparison and contrast in essay writing serve as essential skills that allow writers to analyze relationships between ideas, concepts, or experiences. Understanding the definition and purpose of this writing method provides clarity on how similarities and differences contribute to stronger arguments and deeper insights. Furthermore, mastering comparison and contrast is highly important not only in academic writing but also in everyday communication, as it fosters critical thinking, effective expression, and the ability to evaluate options in various contexts.

1. Comparison and Contrast in Essay Writing

Comparison and contrast essays are a fundamental form of academic and everyday writing that help readers analyze similarities and differences between subjects. These essays serve a dual purpose: they sharpen critical thinking skills and help articulate complex ideas clearly. To begin understanding this form, it's essential to grasp the definition and purpose of comparison and contrast writing, as well as its importance in academic contexts and real-life communication. At the heart of

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CHAPTER 2
COMPARISON AND CONTRAST'S OUTLINE

Ince Rezky Naing, M.Pd

A. Introduction

Outlining is a crucial preparatory step in academic writing, serving as a roadmap that guides the writer in organizing ideas logically before the drafting stage. An essay outline provides a skeletal framework that enables writers to determine the sequence, hierarchy, and relationships among ideas, ensuring clarity and coherence throughout the composition (Oshima & Hogue, 2006). In the context of comparison and contrast essays, outlining becomes particularly important because it helps writers maintain balance between the two subjects being analyzed and avoid unnecessary digressions.

The significance of outlining lies in its ability to enhance the writer's focus, save time during the drafting process, and improve the overall structure of the essay. According to Bailey (2014), an outline helps prevent the inclusion of irrelevant information and supports the logical progression of arguments. Without an outline, writers may struggle with organization, leading to repetitive points or incomplete coverage of essential ideas. This is especially problematic in comparison and contrast writing, where parallelism and consistency are essential for reader comprehension.

Another advantage of outlining is that it encourages strategic decision-making before the writing process begins.

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CHAPTER 3
DRAFTING AND EDITING COMPARISON AND CONTRAST ESSAY

Delfia Herwanis, S. Ag., M. Pd., Ph. D

A. Introduction

The drafting and editing stages of the writing process are the most important. Students must write a comparison and contrast essay that includes two or more concepts, things, or events and explains how they are alike and different. The students will be led through the process of producing an essay that is cohesive and editing it for clarity, coherence, grammar, and structure. This chapter will take them through the steps.

1. The Purpose of Comparison and Contrast Essay

A comparison and contrast essay is designed to analyse the similarities and/or differences between two subjects. The goal is not merely to list characteristics but to reveal meaningful insights or patterns that can enhance the reader's understanding of the topic (Oshima & Hogue, 1998). This style of essay takes critical thinking, as students must identify not only what to compare but also how to express the comparison rationally and persuasively.

2. The Function of Drafting in Essay Composition

Drafting denotes the preliminary phase of writing in which concepts are articulated into phrases and paragraphs. This phase emphasises content generation over flawless execution. In creating a comparison and contrast essay, one must organise

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CHAPTER 4
EDITING COMPARISON AND CONTRAST ESSAY

Prof. Dr. H. Muhammad Basri D, M. Hum

After completing the initial draft of a comparison and contrast essay, the next important stage is editing. This stage aims to transform the initial draft into a neat, clear, flowing, and convincing piece of writing. This chapter provides a comprehensive guide to improving a comparison and contrast essay by addressing two types of editing: global and local concerns. Global editing focuses on refining the overall structure of the essay, ensuring each idea is logically organized, and strengthening the clarity of the thesis and the comparative aspects discussed. Meanwhile, local editing focuses on refining details at the sentence level, such as grammatical accuracy, punctuation, appropriate word choice, and the correct application of writing conventions.

This chapter consists of three sections that cover the editing process as a whole. Section 4.1 Understanding the Editing Process explains the primary purpose of editing, how it differs from revision, and how to assess the organization of ideas, thesis clarity, and paragraph development. Section 4.2 Improving Language, Style, and Coherence focuses on improving sentence flow, choosing the right words, eliminating unnecessary repetition, and maintaining a consistent tone. It also discusses the effective use of conjunctions and parallel structures to strengthen the cohesiveness of the text. Section 4.3 Applying Editing Strategies and Finalizing the Essay provides practical guidance for conducting self-editing and peer review,

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CHAPTER 5
TOPIC SENTENCE AND SUPPORTING SENTENCE OF CAUSE AND EFFECT ESSAY

Dr. Shaumiwaty, S.S., M.Hum

A. Definition of Cause and Effect Essay

1. Definition of Cause and Effect Essay

A cause and effect essay is a type of academic writing that focuses on analyzing the relationship between a particular event or phenomenon (cause) and the resulting impact or consequence (effect) (Ahmad et al., 2023; Tjalla et al., 2019).

a. Cause: the reason why an event occurs.

b. Effect: the result or outcome that follows from the event.

This type of essay goes beyond merely presenting facts. It emphasizes:

a. Logic: the connection between cause and effect must be clear and reasonable.

b. Interconnection: each effect should be directly linked to its cause.

c. Critical analysis: readers are guided to understand the phenomenon in depth, including how one effect can be traced to multiple causes.

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CHAPTER 6
DRAFTING AND EDITING CAUSE AND EFFECT ESSAY

Dr. Muhammad Yunus, S.S., M.Pd

A. Introduction

The Cause and Effect Essay is a type of academic writing that analyzes the reasons (causes) for a certain event, situation, or phenomenon, and its resulting consequences (effects). Mastering the drafting and editing process ensures clarity, coherence, and persuasiveness in your writing.

Purpose of this chapter:

1. To guide students in drafting a well-structured cause and effect essay.
2. To develop skills in revising and editing for academic standards.
3. To avoid common mistakes in cause-effect reasoning.

B. Drafting the Cause and Effect Essay

1. Understanding the Purpose

A cause and effect essay can be:

a. Cause-focused: Explains why something happens.

Definition:
A cause-focused essay explains *why* something happens.

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CHAPTER 7
EDITING CAUSE AND EFFECT ESSAY

Linda Fitri Ibrahim, M.Hum

A. Introduction

Writing is a system for interpersonal communication using visible signs or graphic symbols (Citravelu et al., 2005). Writing is already and will continue to be an important part of our everyday lives. Writing is the most effective way to communicate. Suppose you read an article in a newspaper that makes you feel angry. Writing a thoughtful letter to the editor can help you express and share your feelings. Furthermore, writing will also bring you surprising insight into yourself.

Essay writing is a form of written communication that allows writers to express ideas, opinions, or arguments on a specific topic. A core element of an essay is the presentation of the writer's perspective. A Cause and effect essay is a piece of exposition that describes the relationship between an event or circumstance and its causes (Carrol et al., 2001). A cause and effect essay explores the relationship between the event or situation (the cause) and its consequences (the effect). It examines the reasons why something happens and the outcomes. The purpose of a cause and effect essay is to educate the reader; the goal is not to persuade, argue, or entertain your readers. As an expository essay writer, we may think of ourselves as the informed explainer who provides our readers with the information they need to think critically about a topic and draw their conclusions.

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CHAPTER 8
TOPIC SENTENCE AND SUPPORTING SENTENCE OF ARGUMENTATIVE ESSAY

Imam Munandar, M.TESOL

A. Definition of Argumentative Essay

An argumentative essay is one of the most essential forms of academic writing, playing a significant role in both education and research since it emphasizes the presentation of arguments in a logical, systematic, and convincing manner. Unlike descriptive or narrative writing, which primarily focuses on providing information or telling a story, the main purpose of an argumentative essay is to defend a particular idea or position through verifiable evidence. Abbas and Herdi (2018) state that an argumentative essay is a scientific piece of writing containing arguments, explanations, proof, or reasoning accompanied by examples, analogies, and objective reviews. This indicates that the essence of an argumentative essay lies not in subjective opinions but in arguments that are measurable, relevant, and supported by facts. Thus, an argumentative essay functions as an intellectual medium to test an idea through pros and cons, leading to a more comprehensive understanding.

The general structure of an argumentative essay can be outlined as follows:

1. Introduction → This section introduces the topic, background, and the rationale for selecting the issue under discussion. The most crucial element of the introduction is the *thesis statement*, which serves as the central claim

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CHAPTER 9
COMPOSING ARGUMENTATIVE ESSAY OUTLINE

Prof. Dr. Andi Tenri Ampa, M. Hum

A. Introduction

A clear and systematic outline is the foundation for writing an effective argumentative essay. In this chapter, students will be guided to organize their ideas and structure their arguments in a planned manner before moving on to the drafting stage. By developing a detailed plan, writers can strengthen their stance on the topic, present evidence coherently, and address opposing viewpoints more confidently and convincingly.

This chapter consists of three main sections. Section 9.1, 'Understanding the Basics of an Argumentative Outline,' explores the essential purposes, components, and benefits of an outline, including the importance of a focused thesis statement and strategic placement of main points. Section 9.2, 'Structuring the Body: Arguments, Evidence, and Responses to Counterarguments,' covers how to present a convincing claim with credible evidence, effectively respond to opposing arguments, and maintain a logical flow. Section 9.3, 'Constructing the Conclusion and Refining the Plan,' focuses on crafting a strong conclusion to reinforce the main argument, leave a lasting impression on the readers, and refine the outline for clarity and coherence.

By following step-by-step instructions, utilizing illustrative examples, and conducting hands-on exercises,

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CHAPTER 10
DRAFTING AND EDITING ARGUMENTATIVE ESSAY

Rayhan Izzati Basith, M.App.Ling

A. Introduction

Writing an argumentative essay is one of the essential academic skills that trains students to think critically, construct logical arguments, and defend a position with strong evidence. An argumentative essay is not merely a medium to express personal opinions, but also a means to cultivate analytical, evaluative, and persuasive abilities.

According to Oshima and Hogue (2006), "An argumentative essay is a kind of essay in which you not only give information but also present an argument with the pros (supporting ideas) and cons (opposing ideas) of an argumentative issue" (p. 142). This definition emphasizes that an argumentative essay requires writers to go beyond presenting information—it demands the ability to think in two directions: weighing both pros and cons before adopting a particular stance.

Similarly, Graff and Birkenstein (2018) describe argumentative writing as an academic practice that allows writers to engage in intellectual conversations. They argue that "argument writing is essentially about entering a conversation with others' ideas and responding with your own" (p. 4). This means that writing an argumentative essay is not simply stating one's own opinion, but entering into a dialogue with other perspectives in a critical and structured manner.

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CHAPTER 11
EDITING ARGUMENTATIVE ESSAY

Tathahira, M.Ed.

A. Introduction

Writing an argumentative essay is one of the core academic skills that requires writers not only to present ideas but also to persuade readers through logical reasoning, valid evidence, and critical engagement with counterarguments. Compared to other types of essays, the argumentative essay is more complex because its success largely depends on the strength of its rhetoric and the effectiveness of its persuasive strategies (Graff & Birkenstein, 2014).

In academic contexts, editing an argumentative essay should not be viewed merely as a process of correcting grammatical errors or polishing writing style. Rather, editing constitutes an evaluative process that focuses on the substance of the argument itself. Writers must ensure that the thesis statement is clear and unambiguous, the main arguments are supported by credible evidence, and counterarguments are addressed in ways that reinforce the writer's position. In other words, editing serves as a process of refining logical reasoning, not merely a technical revision.

Furthermore, editing an argumentative essay requires sensitivity to the audience. According to Hyland (2006), academic language carries an interpersonal dimension in which writers must manage their stance toward readers through word

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AUTHOR'S BIODATA



Dr. Lalu Suhirman, M.Pd.

Lalu Suhirman akrab dipanggil Herman, seorang penulis, peneliti dan Dosen di Program Studi Pendidikan Bahasa Inggris, Fakultas Keguruan dan Ilmu Pendidikan (FKIP) Universitas Cenderawasih, Jayapura – Papua sejak tahun 1989. Jabatan Fungsional Lektor Kepala IV/C (Associate Professor) dalam bidang Pendidikan Bahasa Inggris (*TEFL - Teaching English as Foreign Language*). Lahir di Desa Tebaban, Kecamatan Sukamulia, Kabupaten Selong – Lombok Timur (LOTIM), Mataram 7 Mei 1963 (untuk urusan administrasi pemerintah memberi tanggal lahir baru tanggal 31 Desember 1963). Anak kelima dari sembilan bersaudara, pasangan H. Lalu Utjan dan Inderawati Nur. Menamatkan pendidikan Sekolah Dasar di SDN Tebaban 1976, Sekolah Menengah Pertama (SMP) di Sukamulia – Selong 1979, dan Sekolah Menegah Atas (SMAN) Ampenan Lombok Barat 1982. Kumudian melanjutkan di Perguruan Tinggi:Program Sarjana (S1) di FKIP Universitas Mataram tamat 1987/1988.

Pada waktu-waktu senggang selama kuliah Penulis mengisi waktunya sebagai Pemandu Wisata (Tour Guide) dan aktif dalam Sanggar Seni Drama. Program Magister-S2 di Universitas Negeri Malang (UM) tahun 2000, dan Program Doktor-S3 di Universitas Negeri Makassar (UNM) 2016. Berkesempatan magang ke Luar Negeri di Amerika Serikat (AS) tahun 2014, mengikuti program SANDWICH – PKPI

AUTHOR'S BIODATA



Ince Rezky Naing, M.Pd.

Dosen Program Studi Pendidikan Bahasa Inggris
Fakultas Keguruan dan Ilmu Pendidikan,
Universitas Cenderawasih

Penulis adalah dosen pada Program Studi Pendidikan Bahasa Inggris, Universitas Cenderawasih, Papua. Ia lahir di Pangkep, Indonesia, pada 17 Juli 1995. Gelar Sarjana Pendidikan Bahasa Inggris diperolehnya dari Universitas Muhammadiyah Makassar pada tahun 2018, dan gelar Magister Pendidikan Bahasa Inggris dari Universitas Negeri Yogyakarta pada tahun 2022.

Bidang minat akademiknya meliputi pengajaran bahasa Inggris (*English Language Teaching*/ELT), teknologi pembelajaran, serta pengembangan literasi di pendidikan tinggi. Sebagai pendidik dan peneliti, ia berkomitmen untuk meningkatkan praktik pengajaran dan hasil belajar mahasiswa, khususnya dalam konteks English as a Foreign Language (EFL).

Selain aktif dalam kegiatan penelitian akademik, pengabdian kepada masyarakat, dan publikasi ilmiah di bidang pendidikan bahasa Inggris, ia juga terlibat dalam berbagai inovasi pedagogis. Buku ini merupakan refleksi dari dedikasinya dalam meningkatkan keterampilan menulis melalui perpaduan pendekatan teoretis dan aplikasi praktis.

AUTHOR'S BIODATA



Delfia Herwanis, S. Ag., M. Pd., Ph. D

Dosen Program Studi Tadris Bahasa Inggris
Fakultas Tarbiyah, Institut Agama Islam Negeri Takengon

Penulis lahir di Aceh Tengah pada tanggal 21 Februari 1976. Saat ini, penulis adalah dosen tetap pada Program Studi Tadris Bahasa Inggris, Fakultas Tarbiyah, Institut Agama Islam Negeri (IAIN) Takengon. Penulis menyelesaikan pendidikan S1 pada Jurusan Sastra Arab di UIN Imam Bonjol Padang, kemudian melanjutkan studi S2 pada Jurusan Pendidikan Bahasa Inggris di Universitas Negeri Padang, dan menyelesaikan studi S3 pada Jurusan Teaching English as a Second Language (TESL) di Universiti Pendidikan Sultan Idris (UPSI) Malaysia.

Penulis telah menekuni bidang penulisan akademik maupun kreatif sejak masa awal perkuliahan, dan berbagai karya tulisnya dapat diakses melalui akun Google Scholar Delfia Herwanis. Selain aktif dalam bidang penulisan dan pengajaran, penulis juga memiliki kepedulian tinggi terhadap kegiatan pengabdian kepada masyarakat, baik dalam lingkup keilmuan Bahasa Inggris maupun di luar bidang keilmuan tersebut, seperti pembinaan keagamaan, pemberdayaan perempuan, serta kegiatan sosial dan edukatif lainnya di lingkungan masyarakat.

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AUTHOR'S BIODATA



Prof. Dr. H. Muhammad Basri D, M. Hum

Dosen Fakultas Sastra, Ilmu Komunikasi, dan Pendidikan/FSIKP) Universitas Muslim Indonesia (UMI) Makassar

Penulis memiliki minat utama dalam bidang penelitian, kajian linguistik, dan interdisiplin ilmu linguistik, meliputi Psikolinguistik, Sosiolinguistik, dan Antropologilinguistik. Selain itu, beliau juga menaruh perhatian besar terhadap kajian sosial-budaya, sastra, ekologi, filsafat, serta pengajaran bahasa Inggris sebagai bahasa asing (TEFL).

Sebagai akademisi produktif, beliau telah menulis sejumlah artikel ilmiah yang diterbitkan di berbagai jurnal internasional, serta menyusun berbagai buku dan modul pembelajaran untuk mendukung proses belajar-mengajar di lingkungan kampus.

Beberapa karya yang telah diterbitkan antara lain:

- *Research Methodology on English Morphology and Syntax*
- *English Word Classes*
- *Cara Menyatakan Pikiran dalam Bahasa Inggris*
- *Building Character in English Communication*
- *Fundamentals of Language Research Methodology*

AUTHOR'S BIODATA



Dr. Shaumiwaty, S.S., M.Hum

Dosen senior pada Program Studi Tadris Bahasa Inggris Pada Fakultas Tarbiyah Institut Agama Islam Negeri Takengon

Penulis lahir di Takengon tanggal 26 Oktober 1970. Setelah menyelesaikan Pendidikan awal, menengah pertama dan menengah atas penulis menlajutkan pendidikan S1 pada Jurusan Sastra Inggris pada Faklutas Sastra Inggris Universitas Islam Sumatera Utara (1997) dan menyelesaikan Pendidikan Profesi Keguruan pada Fakultas Ilmu Pendidikan IKIP Medan (1998) dan melanjutkan S2 pada Fakultas Ilmu Budaya Porgram Studi Linguistik pada Universitas Sumatera Utara (2002) dan menyelesaikan program Doktoral pada Fakultas Ilmu Budaya konsentrasi Phonology Universitas Sumatera Utara (2012)

e-mail: shaumiwaty26@gmail.com

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AUTHOR'S BIODATA



Dr. Muhammad Yunus, S.S., M.Pd.

Dosen Program Studi Pendidikan Bahasa Inggris
Fakultas Sastra, Ilmu Komunikasi, dan Pendidikan,
Universitas Muslim Indonesia

Penulis lahir di Panyili Bone tanggal 14 Juni 1968. Penulis adalah dosen tetap pada Program Studi Pendidikan Bahasa Inggris, Fakultas Sastra-Ilmu Komunikasi-dan Pendidikan, Universitas Muslim Indonesia (UMI). Menyelesaikan pendidikan S1 pada Jurusan Sastra Inggris UMI tahun 1994, melanjutkan S2 pada Jurusan Pendidikan Bahasa, di Universitas Negeri Makasar (UNM) tahun 2004, dan S3 pada Jurusan Pendidikan Bahasa Inggris di UNM Makassar tahun 2012. Penulis memperoleh beasiswa DIKTI dalam program Peningkatan Kualitas Publikasi Internasional (PKPI) di Northern Illinois University, USA tahun 2014.

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AUTHOR'S BIODATA



Linda Fitri Ibrahim, M.Hum

Penulis lahir di Takengon pada tanggal 10 Juni 1986. Penulis merupakan dosen tetap Program Studi Tadris Bahasa Inggris Fakultas Tarbiyah IAIN Takengon, Aceh Tengah, Aceh. Menyelesaikan pendidikan S1 pada program studi Tadris Bahasa Inggris STAI Gajah Putih Takengon pada tahun 2008, kemudian menyelesaikan magister program studi Linguistik Terapan Bahasa Inggris di Universitas Negeri Medan pada tahun 2011. Penulis menekuni bidang menulis dan beberapa karya penulis dalam karya ilmiah dan book chapter mencakup bidang Pendidikan bahasa Inggris, semantics, morphology, language acquisition dan lainnya.

Pengalaman penulis sebagai dosen sejak tahun 2008 sampai saat ini. Disamping menjadi dosen, penulis pernah menjadi kepala UPT. Pengembangan Bahasa IAIN Takengon dan saat ini menjadi sekretaris LPPM IAIN Takengon.

e-mail: lindaraffasya6@gmail.com

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AUTHOR'S BIODATA



Imam Munandar, M.TESOL

Dosen pada Program Studi Tadris Bahasa Inggris Pada
Fakultas Tarbiyah Institut Agama Islam Negeri Takengon

Penulis lahir di Meureudu 26 Juni 1986. Setelah menyelesaikan Pendidikan awal, menengah pertama dan menengah atas di Meureudu, penulis melanjutkan pendidikan S1 pada Jurusan Pendidikan Bahasa Inggris pada Fakultas Tarbiyah Institut Agama Islam Negeri Ar-Raniry Banda Aceh dan lulus pada tahun 2009. Pada tahun 2008 memperoleh Pendidikan non-gelar dari University of California Extension Amerika Serikat dalam program English Intensive Program. Selanjutnya melanjutkan S2 pada Faculty of Art and Education, Deakin University Australia dan lulus tahun 2011

e-mail: imameducator@gmail.com

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AUTHOR'S BIODATA



Prof. Dr. Andi Tenri Ampa, M. Hum

Dosen Program Studi Pendidikan Bahasa Inggris
Universitas Muhammadiyah Makassar.

Penulis lahir di Bone tanggal 31 Desember 1959. Penulis menyelesaikan pendidikan S1 pada Jurusan Pendidikan Bahasa Inggris di Universitas Negeri Makassar (IKIP) dan melanjutkan studi S2 pada Jurusan Lingusitics di Universitas Hasanuddin Makassar, dan S3 pada Jurusan Pendidikan Bahasa Inggris di Universitas Negeri Makassar.

e-mail: anditenri.ampa@unismuh.ac.id

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AUTHOR'S BIODATA



Rayhan Izzati Basith, S.Pd.I., M.App.Ling.

Dosen Program Studi Pendidikan Bahasa Inggris
Universitas Syiah Kuala

Penulis lahir di Banda Aceh tanggal 17 April 1992. Penulis adalah dosen tetap pada Program Studi Pendidikan Bahasa Inggris Fakultas Keguruan dan Ilmu Pendidikan. Menyelesaikan pendidikan S1 pada Program Studi Pendidikan Bahasa Inggris Universitas Islam Negeri Ar-Raniry, Banda Aceh dan melanjutkan S2 pada Program *Master of Applied Linguistics, Faculty of Arts, Monash University, Australia.*

Sebagai akademisi muda, minat penelitian beliau berfokus pada linguistik terapan, khususnya pada Pragmatics dan Teaching English for Young Learners. Beliau aktif menulis artikel ilmiah, mengikuti konferensi nasional maupun internasional, serta terlibat dalam berbagai program peningkatan mutu pendidikan bahasa Inggris.

Selain mengajar, beliau juga berperan dalam penguatan kompetensi mahasiswa di bidang academic writing, critical thinking, dan penelitian bahasa. Kontribusinya dalam dunia pendidikan diharapkan mampu meningkatkan kualitas lulusan Pendidikan Bahasa Inggris agar siap menghadapi tantangan global.

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AUTHOR'S BIODATA



Tathahira, M.Ed.

Dosen Program Studi Tadris Bahasa Inggris
Fakultas Tarbiyah IAIN Takengon

Penulis lahir di Tapaktuan tanggal 14 Juli 1992. Penulis adalah dosen tetap pada Program Studi Tadris Bahasa Inggris Fakultas Tarbiyah, IAIN Takengon. Menyelesaikan pendidikan S1 pada Program Studi Pendidikan Bahasa Inggris Universitas Islam Negeri Ar-Raniry, Banda Aceh dan melanjutkan S2 pada Program Master of Education, Faculty of Education, Monash University, Australia.

Sebagai akademisi muda, minat penelitian beliau berfokus pada Pengembangan Kurikulum dan English Language Teaching Method. Beliau aktif menulis artikel ilmiah, mengikuti konferensi nasional maupun internasional, serta terlibat dalam berbagai program peningkatan mutu pendidikan Bahasa Inggris.

Selain mengajar, beliau juga berperan sebagai Ketua Program Studi Tadris Bahasa Inggris dalam menjamin pelayanan akademik dan penyelenggaraan kegiatan untuk pengembangan prodi. Kontribusinya dalam dunia pendidikan diharapkan mampu meningkatkan kualitas lulusan Tadris Bahasa Inggris agar siap menghadapi tantangan global.

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